General Tips

What to expect (topics we went over)

Control Panel Essentials

Users

LSP

Services

Shares

Updates

File Management

Basic Forensics

Google

- Best friend

Google probably doesn’t work due to school proxy, so use DuckDuckGo

- Also best friend

If DuckDuckGo doesn’t work use Bing

- Not best friend

Pacing

- Take breaks to clear mind
- Make sure you don’t go too slow

Restart if necessary, make sure it is approved by the team before doing so

Teamwork

- Communication isn’t really needed in the first few rounds, but later it is critical
- Don’t think you’re soloing the image - think of it as a collaborative effort

Subbing Out

- Bring in a fresh mind
- In a team of 6, one person will sub out halfway through competition unless the other cannot make it
- Max 5 people per team competing at the same time

READ THE README

Important info in readme, don’t forget to add a user if needed or do other requests like leave a folder shared or leave remote desktop on

Checklist

Very helpful summary/plan of what you need to do

Going without the checklist can result in you forgetting something

Don’t rely too much on this however!

Logging

VERY IMPORTANT

Log your activity as you go - this will keep track of what you have already done, and if you restart you will have something of a guide to follow to regain your points

DON’T LOCK YOURSELF OUT

I’d recommend you set your own password once more before restarting and tell your teammates to record or monitor your typing the new password down so that you can actually log in.

Alternatively, since you don’t even need to set a password for your own account, you can leave it be. (you still need to set passwords for other users, however)

You can also have one of the admins as your “backup” and memorize the password for them

What if I locked myself out?

If you screwed up and wish to start again with a fresh competition image, you are allowed to restart as long as you

- don’t run multiple instances of the same image at once
- don’t go over the time limit

How to fully restart a VM image (back to 0 points)

1. **Suspend/Power Off** the image you want to remove
    a. Suspending is faster
2. Delete **ALL** files associated with your image (the extraction folder)
    a. If you can't delete a file because it is in use by another program:
        i. Find the process running vmware (typically *vmware-vmx.exe*) and kill it
        ii. If above doesn't work, restart your computer
        iii. If you still can't delete all the VM files, pull the power and Ethernet cable and work on a different computer (insert cables back after done)
3. Once you have *ensured* your previous image no longer exists, re-extract
4. Start the image as you would normally without screwing things up

*Note that you are not compensated for the time lost

When to restart

Restart when

- Your score is unrecoverable and you go into the negatives
- Your team has agreed that you can get those points back in time

Do NOT restart when

- There are 10 minutes left
- You have close to 100 and you have an hour left and it doesn’t matter if you get those extra points

For those in advanced

If you plan to use scripts, make sure you have thoroughly tested them to see if they work as intended

ex: make sure the password you supply is indeed the password it sets (special characters can mess things up sometimes)

EVERYONE ELSE IS THE ENEMY! Make sure you don’t accidentally yell out answers.

Round 1 shouldn’t be too hard. Think simple and double check.

Good luck Windows munchkins! You can claim you are carrying your team, since you account for > 50% of the whole competition

R1-R4 total points: Windows (800) Linux (500) Cisco (260)

Reminder for R1:
Windows 10
Windows 2016
Ubuntu 14